

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

- Allowing your partner or a family member to have too much control over your finances (though this can be due to financial abuse, in which case it is *not* your lack of boundaries that are the problem).
- Feeling unable to say no to work because you're anxious that you'll need the money later.

Think about whether any of these apply to you, or if there is some other way in which a lack of boundaries is damaging your relationship with money, because the first stage of setting a boundary is identifying why you need it, and where it needs to go – like a fence. Next, you need to start enforcing the boundary, which may not be easy. Some ways to enforce your new boundary are:

Make sure that you have the vocabulary to communicate your boundary effectively but politely

The essence of this is saying 'no', but often a little more context is needed for the person to understand that you are serious, and that you're not upset with them or being rude. Try phrases like:

- I'm sorry, that's not in my budget right now. Maybe next month.
- I can't afford that right now, but thank you for asking me.
- I'm sorry but I don't have the money to help you out right now, is there another way that I can support you?
- I'm not sure you entirely understand my circumstances –